

Teysa Karlov — Afterlife

Bracket 3 · 1/3 Game Changers · every death happens twice · 100 cards

Nonland 64	Avg MV 2.63	Token makers 12	Outlets 7	Drainers 10
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COMMANDER (1)

1 Teysa Karlov  4

LANDS (36)

- 1 Bojuka Bog 
- 1 Brightclimb Pathway 
- 1 Cabal Coffers 
- 1 Castle Ardenvale 
- 1 Castle Locthwain 
- 1 Caves of Koilos 
- 1 Command Tower 
- 1 Concealed Courtyard 
- 1 Eiganjo, Seat of the Empire 
- 1 Fetid Heath 
- 1 Godless Shrine 
- 1 High Market 
- 1 Isolated Chapel 
- 1 Mortuary Mire 
- 1 Phyrexian Tower 
- 6 Plains 
- 1 Scrubland 
- 1 Shattered Sanctum 
- 1 Silent Clearing 
- 7 Swamp 
- 1 Tainted Field 
- 1 Takenuma, Abandoned Mire 
- 1 Urborg, Tomb of Yawgmoth 
- 1 Vault of the Archangel 
- 1 Westvale Abbey 

RAMP & MANA (7)

- 1 Arcane Signet  2
- 1 Black Market Connections  3
- 1 Orzhov Signet  2
- 1 Pitiless Plunderer  4
- 1 Smothering Tithe  4
- 1 Sol Ring  1
- 1 Talisman of Hierarchy  2

CARD DRAW (9)

- 1 Corrupted Conviction  1
- 1 Deadly Dispute  2
- 1 Grim Haruspex  3
- 1 Midnight Reaper  3
- 1 Morbid Opportunist  3
- 1 Phyrexian Arena  3
- 1 Skullclamp  1
- 1 Vampiric Rites  1
- 1 Village Rites  1

REMOVAL & INTERACTION (7)

- 1 Anguished Unmaking  3
- 1 Despark  2
- 1 Generous Gift  3
- 1 Path to Exile  1
- 1 Plumb the Forbidden  2
- 1 Swords to Plowshares  1
- 1 Vanishing Verse  2

BOARD WIPES (1)

- 1 The Meathook Massacre  2

TOKEN ENGINES (17)

- 1 Adeline, Resplendent Cathar  3
- 1 Bitterbloom Bearer  2
- 1 Bitterblossom  2
- 1 Court of Grace  4
- 1 Doomed Traveler  1
- 1 Elenda, the Dusk Rose  4
- 1 Hallowed Spiritkeeper  3
- 1 Imperious Oligarch  2
- 1 Lingerin Souls  3
- 1 Ministrant of Obligation  3
- 1 Ocelot Pride  1
- 1 Oketra's Monument  3
- 1 Ophiomancer  3
- 1 Orzhov Enforcer  2
- 1 Sengir Autocrat  4
- 1 Teysa, Orzhov Scion  3
- 1 Thalisse, Reverent Medium  5

TOKEN DOUBLERS (2)

- 1 Anointed Procession  4
- 1 Mondrak, Glory Dominus  4

SACRIFICE OUTLETS (5)

- 1 Ashnod's Altar  3
- 1 Phyrexian Altar  3
- 1 Priest of Forgotten Gods  2
- 1 Viscera Seer  1
- 1 Woe Strider  3

DRAIN PAYOFFS (10)

- 1 Bastion of Remembrance  3
- 1 Blood Artist  2
- 1 Bloodletter of Aclazotz  4
- 1 Corpse Knight  2
- 1 Cruel Celebrant  2
- 1 Elas il-Kor, Sadistic Pilgrim  2
- 1 Marauding Blight-Priest  3
- 1 Marionette Apprentice  2
- 1 Mirkwood Bats  4
- 1 Zulaport Cutthroat  2

RECURSION & FINISHERS (5)

- 1 Elspeth, Storm Slayer  5
- 1 Luminous Broodmoth  4
- 1 Reassembling Skeleton  2
- 1 Sorin, Lord of Innistrad  4
- 1 Vito, Thorn of the Dusk Rose  3

TEYSA KARLOV — PILOT'S GAMEPLAN

0. The one-paragraph version

Every death happens twice — but only once you have something to kill. Teysa makes nothing herself, so the first job every game is **bodies**: get a token maker down early, then another. Only then does the second job start, which is making each death worth as much as possible. A 1/1 Spirit dying with Teysa and three drainers out is worth six triggers. Your creatures also leave something behind when they die, so removal and wraths are less punishing for you than for anyone else at the table.

Rebuilt 2026-09-24 after ten games stalled on turn 10: the list now has 12 token makers that need nothing to die first, up from 6. See `decisions.md`.

1. The curve you actually have

	MV≤1	MV2	MV3	MV4	MV5	MV6+	avg
Nonland (64)	10	20	20	12	2	0	2.63

MV≤2 is 30 cards and **nothing costs more than 5**. You should never be stuck.

2. What Teysa does and does not double

DOES double (the event is a creature dying): Blood Artist · Zulaport Cutthroat · Cruel Celebrant · Bastion of Remembrance · Elas il-Kor · Marionette Apprentice · every afterlife trigger · Teysa, Orzhov Scion's Spirits · Elenda's death tokens · Hallowed Spiritkeeper · Pitiless Plunderer · Midnight Reaper · Grim Haruspex · **Skullclamp (four cards)**.

Does NOT double: Mirkwood Bats (triggers on *creating* and *sacrificing* a token, not on dying) · Marauding Blight-Priest and Vito (life-gain triggers) · Oketra's Monument (cast trigger) · Adeline (attack trigger) · Court of Grace (upkeep trigger) · Thalisse and Ocelot Pride (end-step triggers) · Morbid Opportunist ("*triggers only once each turn*" — still one card).

Luminous Broodmoth triggers twice but only returns the creature once — the second trigger finds the card already back on the battlefield as a new object (CR 400.7) and does nothing.

She still doubles everything when she dies in the same wipe — dies-triggers look back in time.

3. The three numbers to track

1. **Deaths this turn** — and remember each is two of every doubled trigger.
2. **Life-gain EVENTS, not life** — Blight-Priest and Vito count sources. Teysa doubling Blood Artist

means *two* gain events per death, so Blight-Priest fires twice too.

1. **Is Bloodletter out on your turn?** Everything doubles again.

4. Opening

T1–T2 — token makers first, then bodies: Bitterblossom, Bitterbloom Bearer, Ocelot Pride, then Doomed Traveler, Orzhov Enforcer, Imperious Oligarch, Viscera Seer, Skullclamp.

T3 — the fork:

- Board already → **Teysa**. She is a multiplier; cast her when there is something to multiply.
- No board → **Adeline** (three Humans every time you attack), **Lingering Souls** (two now, two more

from the graveyard), **Oketra's Monument** (a token for every creature spell) or **Ophiomancer**.

T4–T6: Court of Grace, Sengir Autocrat, Luminous Broodmoth, Anointed Procession or Mondrak — then a drainer, then start sacrificing.

Mulligans. Keep 3 lands with both colours and a token maker or a 1–2 drop. You do not need Teysa in the opener.

5. The engine to look for

Free outlet + Blood Artist + Zulaport + Teysa. One 1/1 Spirit sacrificed is 2 focused (Artist ×2) and 2 to each opponent (Zulaport ×2), plus 4 life to you, which is 4 Blight-Priest triggers — **another 4 to each**. That is roughly 20 across the table for one token, before Bastion or Cruel Celebrant.

Skullclamp on any 1/1 is four cards. Equip, it dies, draw four. This is the best draw engine in either deck and it is why Divine Visitation and Cathars' Crusade are deliberately absent.

Luminous Broodmoth makes every non-flyer die twice. Imperious Oligarch dies → two Spirits and it comes back → dies again → two more Spirits. Four bodies and four rounds of drain from one 2-drop.

Ocelot Pride at 10 permanents copies every token that entered this turn. Lands count. Once you have the city's blessing, an Adeline attack or a Lingering Souls turn doubles at your end step.

6. Sequencing within your turn

1. **Upkeep** — Bitterblossom, Bitterbloom Bearer, Ophiomancer, Court of Grace, Phyrexian Arena.
2. **Main 1** — **Bloodletter first if you have it.** Then bodies.
3. **Attack with tokens.** Adeline adds a Human per opponent, tapped and attacking. Teysa gives

tokens **vigilance and lifelink**, so attacking costs you no blockers and every attacking token is a separate life-gain event for Blight-Priest and Vito. Vault of the Archangel adds deathtouch on top. **If you are the monarch (Court of Grace), keep enough back to stop combat damage to you.**

1. **Sacrifice in the second main**, after combat damage and after Thalisse would count.
2. **End step** — Thalisse creates X Spirits where X is tokens made this turn; Ocelot Pride makes a

Cat if you gained life (and copies the turn's tokens with the city's blessing); the monarch draws. **Do your sacrificing before these only if the extra deaths are lethal; otherwise let them count first and sacrifice on the next turn.**

7. The kill

Two routes:

- **Grind:** attack with lifelinking tokens each turn with Blight-Priest and Vito out. Ten attacking

tokens is ten gain events — ten to each opponent from Blight-Priest and ten more from Vito to one.

- **Burst:** The Meathook Massacre with three drainers out. Teysa doubles every death trigger, and

dies-triggers look back, so your own drainers dying in the wipe still pay. **Check Blight-Priest and Vito are expendable first — they have no look-back and contribute nothing.**

8. The declared combo (assembles ~turn 6–7)

Teysa + Pitiless Plunderer + Reassembling Skeleton + a free outlet.

Sacrifice the Skeleton → Teysa doubles Plunderer → **two Treasures** → pay 1  to return the Skeleton → repeat. Net zero mana. Each loop is two Blood Artist triggers, two Zulaport, two Bastion. Announce every iteration and let opponents respond; stop when the table is dead.

Cutting **Reassembling Skeleton** removes this entirely. Ashnod's Altar alone does not enable it (  cannot pay the Skeleton's .

9. Mistakes to avoid

1. **Casting Teysa on an empty board** into open mana. She multiplies; she does not create.
2. **Forgetting she does NOT double Mirkwood Bats, Blight-Priest or Vito.**
3. **Forgetting tokens have lifelink and vigilance** — attack; it is free and each attacker is a

gain event.

1. **Wiping while Blight-Priest or Vito are your only payoffs.**
2. **Equipping Skullclamp to something with toughness 2** — it needs to be a 1/1 to die.
3. **Sacrificing before your end step when Thalisse is out** and the extra Spirits would have been

bigger than the drain.

1. **Forgetting Midnight Reaper and Grim Haruspex are NONTOKEN-only.** Your Spirit tokens dying do

not trigger them.

1. **Letting Sengir Autocrat leave before its Serfs.** When it leaves, the Serfs are **exiled**, not

killed — no death triggers. If it is targeted, sacrifice the Serfs in response.